

Barons bow twice—

# Pels prove they're still in the fight

NEW ORLEANS, La., June 6—It's an eight-club fight in the Southern Assn. season of 1956.

Andy Cohen and his New Orleans Pelicans came clamoring out of the basement last night with double-header proof that they, too, must be considered in on the proceedings.

The eighth-placers knocked off the league-leading Barons from Birmingham twice, 6 to 3, and 8 to 2, to run their new winning streak to five straight.

MAY WAS a skidding month for the Pelicans. But they'd righted themselves to take three in a row on the road as June began.

"We're not as bad as we've looked," Cohen has insisted all the way.

Birmingham was not inclined to debate the point as the teams headed into the third game of their six-game series here tonight.

BIRMINGHAM knows. Arnold Portocarrero and Jim O'Reilly know it especially well.

Portocarrero was the loser in last night's seven-inning opener. The Pels locked it up with a four-run third.

O'Reilly caught the second game loss which saw Outfielder Frank Wehner make his "emergency" pitching debut. He gave up two hits in one and two-thirds innings, no runs.

Tonight's Birmingham pitching assignment was expected to go either to John Wingo or Wilson Parsons, both right-handers. It's a single game, with another double-header tomorrow night.

LAST NIGHT the Barons were held to six hits in the opener (by Lenny Yochim, Chuck Churn and Don Kildoo) and to five in the nightcap by Don Danleis. Two of the five were home runs by Fritz Brickell and John Blanchard. They were all the Baron scoring there was.

Portocarrero set the Pels down in order in the first two innings of the short game. But a double by Rice, a fielder's choice, a single by Barone, double by Powers and single by Henley sent four runs over.

A double by Marasco and single by Grote got one for the Barons in the fourth and they

came close with a pair in the fifth which saw Churn relieve Yochim. When Suplizio doubled with one out in the sixth Kildoo came on to preserve the win. Lloyd Merritt gave up two more New Orleans runs in the sixth.

THE PELS GOT TO O'Reilly for two in the first inning of the nightcap when Barone doubled, Powers walked, Henley was awarded first on Blanchard's interference and Banko singled.

O'Reilly, wild, walked in another run in the second, and Panko's sacrifice fly made it 4-0.

Brickell's home run, high over the left field fence, was the first Baron run in the fifth. New Orleans matched it with doubles by Grunwald and Rice in the home half.

Two more walks and a single by Piver brought another run in and Merritt back to the mound in the sixth. Rice doubled off him, scoring Panko with No. 7.

Blanchard hit his homer in the seventh and the Pels added a final run off Merritt before Wehner came on for his mound debut.

LAST NIGHT'S double defeat cut the Barons' league league to four and one-half games as second-place Mobile turned back Atlanta, 8-7.

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